

EYE ON EXPANSION

DLF Emporio, which offers 300,000 sq. ft of retail space, will look to expand in the near future

ury stores at that time has been replaced with simultaneous global launches. Add to that the almost similar price tags and the buying power that comes in the form of very high incomes, unicorns and share values and Esops that come with what I call the new cohort of Gold Collar professionals.”

According to Gagan Randev, Executive Director at Sotheby's International Realty, India's market potential is on the rise with the increase in earnings, with luxury real estate also booming. “There has been a noticeable difference in the way incomes and aspirations have changed especially post pandemic... the demand for luxury products has increased,” he says, adding that disposable incomes and aspirations are also on the rise in Tier II and III cities.

EXPERTS SAY THE very definition of luxury has changed over the years from the time people used to see Tommy Hilfiger and Coach as luxury brands to understanding the price-value equation—the heritage of the brand to what goes into making a luxury product to why luxury products cost so much. “In addition to the heritage and craftsmanship, these brands also enhance the personality and confidence levels among the customers socially,” says the RBL spokesperson.

When it comes to luxury retail representation in India, RBL leads with 94 brands including Tiffany & Co., Balenciaga, Bottega Veneta, Ferragamo, Giorgio Armani, Ermenegildo Zegna, Armani/Caffè, Tumi, Burberry, Canali, Tod's, and Villeroy & Boch, among others. RBL also has under its umbrella Indian couture brands such as Manish Malhotra, Ritu Kumar, Abu Jani Sandeep Khosla and Rahul Mishra.

The evolution of a luxury market depends on four 'A's—affordability, aesthetic refinement, awareness, and accessibility, says the RBL spokesperson. “Affordability comes from the creation of wealth, but that alone isn't enough. Aesthetic refinement is the ability to differentiate between a premium, super premium and luxury product and being able to identify and understand what is luxury. Then comes the awareness part through social media, fashion weeks and travelling. And finally, the accessibility. When all these factors play in tandem with each other, the market evolves.”



PHOTO BY HARDIK CHHABRA



“On one hand, we have brands in talks with us who want to launch in India... on the other we have tenants who want to expand... We currently have about 140 brands and hope to add another 100”

PUSHPA BECTOR
SENIOR EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR &
BUSINESS HEAD, DLF RETAIL